L I N U X · P L A T F O R M · A U T O M A T I O N

JERALD SHEETS

Staff Linux Platform & Configuration-Management Architect

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Puppet Enterprise	OpenVox / VoxPupuli	RHEL / Linux Fleets	Security Automation

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Staff-level Linux platform and configuration-management architect with 20+ years operating enterprise fleets. Specialist in Puppet Enterprise and OpenVox — the VoxPupuli community's open-source continuation of Puppet Community — including r10k, Hiera, roles and profiles, and CI. Proven at SpaceXai, Oak Ridge National Laboratory (ORNL) and U.S. Government PE, PayPal security automation, and Puppet Labs partner consulting. Author, reviewer, trainer, and VoxPupuli / OpenVox contributor.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Configuration Mgmt	Puppet Enterprise · OpenVox (VoxPupuli; successor to Puppet Community) · Hiera · r10k / Code Manager · Roles & Profiles
Automation & DevOps	CI/CD · Jenkins · GitHub Actions · Docker · Vagrant · Golden-image provisioning · Kickstart / PXE
Cloud & Platforms	AWS · GCP · RHEL / Rocky · Linux & UNIX fleets · OpenStack
Quality & Testing	rspec-puppet · Serverspec · Onceover · Litmus · Beaker
Languages & Tooling	Bash · Perl · Git · Python (working) · SQL
Leadership & Security	Team lead · SME consulting · training · SOPs · audit · VoxPupuli / OpenVox contributor

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SpaceXai — Dec 2025 – Present

Sr. Linux Systems Engineer — IT Systems — *Remote*

- Architect Puppet Enterprise automation for worldwide SpaceXai infrastructure: modules, tests, and CI/CD. Pair PE with OpenVox — VoxPupuli's continuation of Puppet Community — for fleet practice, SOPs, compliance, and audit.
- Design and maintain OpenVox GUI — open-source operator platform for OpenVox/Puppet Community fleets (dashboard, hierarchical ENC, Bolt, r10k, CA, PQL) — and contribute it back to the VoxPupuli / OpenVox ecosystem.

Oak Ridge National Laboratory (UT-Battelle) — Mar 2023 – Nov 2025

Sr. Linux Systems Administrator — Puppet Automation — *Remote*

- Led Puppet Community automation (the open-source line now continued as OpenVox by VoxPupuli) for the ORNL DAAC — NASA-facing biogeochemical data systems used by NASA, NOAA, and other federal partners.
- Architected highly available RHEL environments and the Puppet estate (install through day-2). Led four engineers; built documentation, best practices, and training.

Penacity, LLC — Mar 2022 – Mar 2023

Sr. Automation Solutions Architect (Contract) — *Remote*

- SME for Puppet Enterprise on-premises and in AWS for U.S. Government (including USDA) and corporate environments — including deployments with no network egress.
- Implemented PE environments, Roles & Profiles, upgrades, and troubleshooting; trained customer teams to run PE without a standing consultant.

PayPal, Inc. — Aug 2016 – Mar 2022

Sr. Continuous Security Strategist — Puppet Automation — *Remote*

- Led Information Security automation as Puppet platform SME; set style guides and standards across security engineering.
- Built continuous-security CI/CD (Jenkins, Puppet, Docker, GitHub, rspec/Onceover/Litmus). Automated golden-image-to-production provisioning in AWS and GCP.

Shadow-Soft — Puppet Labs Partner Consulting Jan 2014 – Aug 2016
Sr. Puppet & Solutions Architect · Team Lead *Remote / Travel*

- Nationwide PE greenfield and brownfield as a Puppet Labs partner consultant: bootstraps, pair programming, architecture reviews. Led four consultants.
- Puppet Camp speaking, blogging, and customer training; automated client AWS and OpenStack footprints with PE.

Accelarad / Nuance — Radiology SaaS Jul 2013 – Jan 2014
Sr. Linux Systems Architect *Atlanta, GA / Remote*

- Primary Linux architect for the radiology SaaS fleet: Puppet Community (Passenger/MCollective), full module estate, Kickstart provisioning, and enterprise monitoring.

Apple, Inc. — GCS Retail Jul 2011 – Jul 2013
Sr. UNIX Systems Engineer *Maiden, NC*

- Architecture and operations for Apple Retail worldwide (OS X Server and RHEL POS); new-store openings and go-lives across IS&T, GNS, and retail.
- Staged Puppet across the global retail chain with no unplanned outages; led OS X Server 10.5.8 to 10.6.x upgrade with NetBoot imaging.

CNN News Systems — BEST Oct 2008 – Aug 2010
Sr. Systems Engineer *Atlanta, GA*

- Owned the CNN digital video library / tape archive (StorageTek SL8500, StorNext, Solaris, RHEL). Migrated the archive to a new data center with no downtime, under budget. 24×7 on-call, no dedicated NOC.

The Weather Channel Interactive Jun 2005 – Oct 2008
Sr. Linux Systems Administrator *Atlanta, GA*

- Operated one of the world's highest-traffic sites (SUSE, Apache, Tomcat). Tuned JVM/serving stack (~30% on key systems); custom Apache/Tomcat builds; introduced VMware for dev/test isolation.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE (SELECTED)

InComm — Sr. Linux Systems Administrator (Contract) · Atlanta · 2010–2011 — Kickstart/PXE, inventory systems, peak-season war-room ops.

Intercontinental Hotels Group — Sr. Technology Consultant · Atlanta · 2010 — RHEL hardening/compliance, asset inventory.

McKesson — Sr. UNIX/Linux Systems Administrator · Atlanta · 2004–2005 — HP-UX / AIX / RHEL for healthcare medication-delivery platforms.

Datatrac — Sr. UNIX/Linux Systems Administrator · Atlanta · 2004 — Multi-platform fleet (AIX, SCO, RHEL).

Our Lady of the Lake RMC — Sr. AIX Systems Administrator · Baton Rouge · 2001–2004 — Enterprise RS/6000 estate (5,000+ users); TSM, ESS/SSA.

Earlier UNIX/Linux roles: Thomson Financial; 3Com (Sprint IP Dial); Tribute, Inc.; Explore Baton Rouge; LSU networking (student).

CERTIFICATIONS

Puppet Certified Professional (2014, 2018, 2019) — #PCP-1121385654 · RHCE/RHCSA — #140-046-236 · Telcordia PRO-INS

Additional training: Puppet Fundamentals & Advanced; AWS / DevOps / Docker / Kubernetes essentials; Sun StorageTek; Quantum StorNext; IBM AIX

PUBLICATIONS, SPEAKING & OPEN SOURCE

Technical Reviewer — Puppet 8 for DevOps Engineers (Packt). Author — "Scaling Puppet Community" / "Scaling Open-Source Puppet."

Linux.com staff author: "Kickstarting Linux Client Installs"; "Making Open Webmail Work." Puppet Camp speaker.

OpenVox GUI — primary author (github.com/cvquesty); OpenVox lint and community docs in the VoxPupuli / OpenVox Project. Amateur radio: KO4JIL.

EDUCATION

Master of Arts, Theological Studies — Evangel University, Springfield, MO (in progress)

Bachelor of Arts, Christian Studies — St. Stephen's University, St. Stephen, NB (2016)

Coursework toward B.S. Music Education — Louisiana State University, Baton Rouge

Technical diploma — International Technical Institute, Baton Rouge (1991; 2nd in class)